Ian McCallum

Naperville, Illinois | ian@beatyourclock.com | ianmccallum.com | linkedin.com/in/mccallumian

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — Expected 2030
Gies College of Business — B.S. Finance & Data Science — *Champaign, IL*

Experience

Founder & Lead Engineer — Dec 2024 – Present
Beat the Clock — *Naperville, IL*

- Founded and solely engineer an AI operations company for trades businesses, taking the product from problem interviews through architecture, build, and go-to-market.
- Shipped **Clockwork**, a ten-stage automated platform across eight screens that turns a missed call into a drafted reply, a priced quote, a confirmed appointment, and a collected invoice.

Lead Developer — 2025 – 2026
Luminate — Virtual Enterprise International — *Aurora, IL*

- Led development of the full storefront for a glow-in-the-dark sports equipment brand: product catalog, curated bundles, and cart spanning training gear and party lines.
- Designed and coded an in-site arcade of three playable games awarding points redeemable for promo codes, giving customers a reason to return between purchases.
- Won **1st Place National** and **1st Place Midwest Regional** for E-Commerce Website against national competition.

Web Developer — 2023 – Present
Freelance — *Naperville, IL*

- Shipped custom sites for paying clients including Imanol VillaGomez (concert videographer for Charli XCX and Playboi Carti), Fortivus Academy (the largest rugby program in Naperville), TMM Photography, and Nics Marketing.
- Ran every engagement solo from scoping through launch, handling client communication and revisions directly.

Creator, YouTube & Twitch — 2019 – 2021
Vokel — *Remote*

- Grew a gaming channel to nearly 500 subscribers and earned Twitch Affiliate status, editing every video in Premiere Pro and After Effects.

Projects

Clockwork — AI Operations Platform | *Python, React, JavaScript, LLM APIs* — Dec 2024 – Present

- Designed the product around an approval-gated agent: every message is drafted for the owner to approve, and the agent earns permission to send a message type on its own only after enough drafts pass unedited — revocable in one tap.
- Separated deterministic pricing from model output so quotes compute from each customer's own rate card, eliminating a class of AI failure where a hallucinated number costs real money.
- Wrote a ten-rule voice specification for the agent and enforced it in the test suite (any violation fails the build), and architected multi-tenant support with strict data isolation between locations.

beatyourclock.com | *JavaScript, HTML, CSS* — 2025

- Built the company site end to end, including an interactive product simulation and a free assessment tool that quantifies the revenue hours a shop loses each week.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, JavaScript, HTML, CSS

Frameworks & Tools: React, Git, Premiere Pro, After Effects

AI & Systems: Agent design, prompt engineering, LLM integration, human-in-the-loop approval workflows, automated testing of model output, multi-tenant architecture

Integrations: Messaging/SMS, payments, scheduling, invoicing

Honors & Activities

Awards: 1st Place National & 1st Place Midwest Regional, E-Commerce Website (VEI); Illinois State Scholar; AP Scholar with Distinction; Magna Cum Laude; Seal of Biliteracy

Activities: National Honor Society; UNICEF Club, Board Member; Youth Soccer Referee (2021–2024)

Additional Work: Target, Food Dept. (2024–Present); Coldwell Banker Dan Firks, Real Estate Runner (Summer 2025)